THOUGHTKIND PRESS · GROUP AGREEMENT

Our group's ground rules

People join this group on different days, so we go over these often. They help everyone get a fair turn and feel safe to take part.

1. **What you hear here stays here.** Other members' names and stories don't leave the room, in conversation, in texts or on social media. You are always free to talk about your own experience.
2. **You can pass.** You can pass on any question or activity, with no reason needed.
3. **One person talks at a time.** Side conversations make it hard to hear and easy to feel talked about.
4. **We share the airtime.** Everyone gets a turn, so the facilitator may pause you to make room.
5. **Speak for yourself, and ask before giving advice.** Say "I found" instead of "you should."
6. **No put-downs.** You can disagree with an idea. You can't insult, mock or threaten a person.
7. **Phones silent and out of sight.** No photos and no recording. Expecting an urgent call? Tell the facilitator before group.
8. **If it gets to be too much, tell us, or step out and come back.** Staff will tell you who to go to and what happens next.

What we can't promise

We all agree to keep each other's stories private, but no one can guarantee that every member always will, so share what feels okay to share. Staff also have limits on what they can keep private. Those are in your program's consent paperwork. Ask staff if you'd like to go over them.

If you join by video

- Join from a private spot. If you can't be alone, use headphones and tell the facilitator privately in chat.
- First names only on your screen.
- No recordings or screenshots, on any device.
- Stay put for the session. Don't join while driving or from a public place.
- Use the raise-hand button or chat to get a turn.
- Follow our camera rule.

Our program also asks (attendance, lateness, substances, contact outside group)

_____

_____

Optional, if your program uses signed agreements:

Member name or signature	Date	Staff
_____	_____	_____

© 2026 Heba El Garhy, Thoughtkind Press. thoughtkindpress.com/guides/group-therapy-ground-rules. Free to print for groups you facilitate. Please do not edit, remove attribution or sell. Sample wording for educational use. It does not replace your program's consent forms, policies or procedures, clinical training, supervision or legal advice. Have it reviewed against your program's policies before use.